

10 Scripts for Following Up on Your Care

Following up on your healthcare shouldn't feel overwhelming.

This printable guide gives you:



Ready-to-use scripts

Fill in the blanks and read directly when calling
Quick-reference tips — Stay confident and effective

FREE PRINTABLE RESOURCE

Part 2: Fill-in-the-Blank Scripts

Script 1: Lab Results

"Hi, my name is _____ and my date of birth is ____/____/_____.

I had lab work done on _____ and haven't received my results yet. Could someone review them with me or let me know when I can expect to hear back?"

Notes: _____

Script 2: Referral Status

"Hi, I'm calling because Dr. _____ submitted a referral to _____ (specialty) for me on or around _____.

I haven't heard from the specialist's office yet. Can you confirm the referral was sent and provide me with the contact information so I can follow up on my end as well?"

Specialist office phone (if provided): _____

Script 3: Imaging/Test Results (MRI, CT, X-ray)

"Hi, my name is _____ and my date of birth is ____/____/_____.

I had a _____ (type of test) done on _____. I'm calling to find out if the results are available and whether I need to schedule a follow-up appointment to discuss them."

Results available? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Pending — Expected by: _____

Script 4: Requesting Records

"Hi, I'd like to request a copy of my recent _____ (lab results / imaging report / visit summary).

Can you tell me the best way to get that — through the patient portal, by fax, or in person?"

Method: ☐ Portal ☐ Fax to: _____ ☐ Pick up on: _____

Script 5: Promised Callback That Never Came

"Hi, I spoke with someone on _____ and was told I'd receive a call back about _____.

I haven't heard back yet and just wanted to follow up. Is there an update?"

New expected callback date: _____

Script 6: Prior Authorization Status

"Hi, my name is _____. Dr. _____ submitted a prior authorization for _____ (medication or procedure) on or around _____.

I'm calling to check on the status. Has it been approved, or is there anything else needed from my end?"

Status: ☐ Approved ☐ Denied ☐ Pending — Additional info needed: _____

Script 7: Post-ER/Urgent Care Follow-Up

"Hi, I was seen in the _____ (ER / urgent care) on _____ and was told to follow up with my primary care doctor.

I'd like to schedule that follow-up appointment. I also want to make sure the records from that visit were sent to your office."

Follow-up scheduled for: _____ Records received? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Script 8: Clarifying Results You Don't Understand

"Hi, I received my _____ (lab results / test results / a message) and I'm not sure I fully understand what it means or what I should do next.

Is it possible to schedule a brief call or appointment to go over this?"

Questions to ask/response: _____

Script 9: Waitlist Check-In

"Hi, I'm on the waitlist for an appointment with Dr. _____ in _____ (specialty). I was originally told the wait would be about _____.

I'm calling to check if anything has opened up sooner, or to confirm I'm still on the list."

Current position/estimated wait: _____

Script 10: Caregiver Calling on Behalf of Someone Else

"Hi, my name is _____, and I'm calling on behalf of _____ (patient name), date of birth ____/____/____.

I am their _____ (relationship). I'm following up on _____.

There should be an authorization on file for me to discuss their care. How can we get an update?"

Authorization confirmed? ☐ Yes ☐ No — Need to submit: _____

Part 3: Quick Reference Card

Before You Call

- ☐ Your full name & DOB
- ☐ Date of test/visit/request
- ☐ Doctor's name
- ☐ What you need

During the Call

- ☐ Write down who you spoke with
- ☐ Ask: "When should I expect to hear back?"
- ☐ Ask: "What's the best number to call if I don't hear back?"
- ☐ Repeat back key info to confirm

After the Call

- ☐ Log it in your tracker
- ☐ Set a reminder to follow up
- ☐ Note any reference numbers
- ☐ File any paperwork

Your Rights as a Patient

- ✓ **You have the right to access your own medical records**
- ✓ **You have the right to understand your diagnosis and treatment options**
- ✓ **You have the right to a timely response from your healthcare providers**
- ✓ **You have the right to ask questions -as many as you need**
- ✓ **Following up isn't being "difficult" it's being smart.**

The 10 Scripts to Follow Up on Your Care was created for educational and informational purposes only.

It is not intended as medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment and should not be relied upon as a substitute for professional medical judgment.

Always consult your own healthcare provider with any questions you may have regarding your medical care, condition, or treatment.



Be Your Best Health Advocate

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